

Online Safety in Sri Lanka



Online Safety Act No. 9 of 2024

The Online Safety Act aims to regulate digital platforms, protect users from harmful content, and prevent misuse of online accounts, ensuring safer digital spaces in Sri Lanka.

What the Act Aims to Protect

01

Personal Protection

To protect persons against harm caused by communication of prohibited statements

02

Judicial Integrity

Preventing online communications that constitute contempt of court or prejudice judicial authority.

03

System Safeguards

Detecting and preventing the misuse of online accounts and automated bots to commit offenses.

04

Financial Prevention

Preventing the financing, promotion, and other support of online locations that repeatedly host prohibited statements.

Who Regulates Online Safety in Sri Lanka?



Online Safety Commission

- 5 Members
- Appointed by president
- 3 Years Term

Experience Required (One or More Fields)

Information technology, law, governance, social services, journalism, science and technology or management

Key Powers & Functions

01 Regulate Content

Remove, block, or stop prohibited statements

02 Ensure Compliance

Issue directives and enforce platform responsibility

03 Support Judiciary

Refer contempt-related matters to courts

04 Monitor & Investigate

Detect violations and work with police

05 Oversee Platforms

Set rules and register social media services

06 Inform Public

Provide accurate information via online portals

07 Advise Government

Guide policies on online safety

08 Administrative Control

Manage staff, contracts, and assets

Key Online Offences You Must Know



False & Harmful Content

Misleading statements affecting public order, security, or health



Online Fraud

Cheating, deception, and identity impersonation



Judicial Offences

Contempt of court and threats to judicial authority



Public Disorder

Incitement to riots, violence, or public panic



Religious Offences

Disturbance or insult to religious beliefs and practices



Harassment & Privacy

Sharing private information to cause harm



Child Abuse

Abuse, exploitation, or harmful content involving children



System Misuse

Use of bots or platforms to commit offences

From Complaint to Court: How the Process Works

